

Identifying Your Product & Target Audience

1- My website aims to address the issue of inadequate pet care by involving the whole family in a shared system and schedule for more effective care of the pet, focused on creating a collaborative calendar to distribute tasks across the household. This is very helpful for families with older children or teens, ensuring they are taking care of pets and learning responsibility. With shared household access and the ability for parents to check it while at work in a separate tab, this will make sure the pet is never unfed or unmedicated, sharing the burden of making sure they are taken care of as proper members of the family. With many people viewing the same schedule and tasks, unintentional neglect will be a thing of the past.

The website is not just for families but for roommates or anyone sharing pet care with another person, allowing pet sitters to be added to the group, with an extension for vets to view progress and what is being done to help the pet recover or stay healthy.

2- The product idea associated with the website will be a shared hub for pet care needs, with users creating profiles that are then invited to a family centered around the pets. Each account will list the pets connected to it, with scheduled or upcoming tasks color-coded to show which pet needs what, such as a dog needing heartworm medicine at 8 AM, which can be done before work, or a simpler task for kids getting home from school: walk the dog at 3, which parents can check when leaving the office to see if their kids have completed the task.

The website will help address these issues by allowing tasks to be scheduled with a separation of kid and adult tasks or shared tasks visible on the schedule, with notifications in a sidebar to show what tasks were recently completed or what is overdue. As a webpage, it can be viewed on a phone or computer screen, allowing easy access to the schedule for multiple people. The group calendar will help everyone stay on task.

3- The website I am making is a more focused productivity and care web app in a business model; it combines features of a calendar/group planner and a tracker for goals achieved this month or streaks, which can be gamified to keep children engaged by dressing up a virtual pet with rewards gained, for example, by walking the dog for a week straight or a month straight.

With its primary purpose being to provide a place to easily sync schedules and take care of the pet as a family and household, the main source of income if it were to become a real product or company would be non-intrusive banner ads from other pet companies such as Petco or Chewy.

4- Help support pets and pet owners by providing a simple way to keep a collaborative, organized method to help share pet responsibility and care. By creating schedules, tracking important events, and making them easy to track and share as a group, the tracker will help reduce the stress of raising a pet while maintaining a busy schedule.

Profile Of Target Audience

The primary audience that this website will be targeting will be:

- Ages 8-60 (kids under adult supervision to adults with kids or within most working ages collaborating as a caretaker or member of a family as guardian, or group living such as roommates of young adults who own a pet together.
- All genders will be included, and it will not be focused on a gender basis.
- Will focus primarily on the United States, with the ability to scale to a multinational at another date.
- Targeting Suburban or Urban areas with places with children or white-collar workers who have time to view their phone or have a tab open on their computer to view throughout the day. Rural areas will be less of an area where this is needed, especially if farmland.
- Average income expected between 40,000 - 120,000 mid to upper-middle class being the primary audience.
- All education levels, especially for kids most likely to receive their first smartphone or be allowed to be home alone, will need to take care of the pet starting around age 13 or 14, so end of middle school - high school and beyond.
- Targeted more towards families than single households or roommates.
- Primarily white-collar workers or office workers.
- 40 hours per week of work, aiming towards full-time professionals who have children and pets; either that or a college roommate scenario of 20+ part-time+ school can make it to 60
- People who frequently use the web, as they need to keep up with updates from the web app and see what issues need to be addressed; people who work on computers, likely accessing the web through a mobile browser or computer.

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Name	Sex	Age	Location	Occupation	Income	Web Use
Sarah Mitchell	Female	42	Columbus, Ohio	Marketing Manager	\$92,000	Uses a computer at work and checks her phone frequently throughout the day. Would use the website to monitor her children's pet-care tasks while she is at work.
Jason Rodriguez	Male	17	Austin, Texas	High School Student	\$2,500	Uses a smartphone and computer daily for school, social media, gaming, and homework. Would use the site to check assigned tasks such as walking or feeding the family dog.
Emily Chen	Female	28	Denver, Colorado	Software Developer	\$105,000	Heavy daily computer and smartphone user. Would use the website with roommates

						to coordinate feeding, walking, and medication for their shared cat and dog.
Michael Thompson	Male	51	Raleigh, North Carolina	Accountant	\$78,000	Uses a computer throughout his workday and checks his phone regularly. Would use the site to make sure his teenage children completed pet-care tasks and to monitor medication schedules.

*Document above generated by ChatGPT

Reasons users may come to the site:

- Checking tasks assigned to them.
- Parents checking up on children's completion of the tasks assigned to them
- Scheduling feeding or walking times
- Coordinate pet care with roommates
- Keeping track of pet medication

How the Visitors Might Use the Site

- Sarah Mitchell (parent): Primarily visits to monitor and organize her family's pet-care responsibilities. She may check the website during her workday to make sure her children have completed important tasks.
- Jason Rodriguez (teenager): Primarily visits to see what he needs to do and mark tasks as completed. Gamification, streaks, and rewards could encourage him to consistently participate.
- Emily Chen (roommate/pet owner): Primarily visits to coordinate shared responsibilities with roommates, schedule recurring tasks, and keep track of the pets' overall care.
- Michael Thompson (parent): Primarily visits to schedule and monitor important care, particularly medication, feeding, and other recurring responsibilities.

Planning & Designing Your Product Website

1- The primary purpose of the website will be to provide a collaborative environment for pet owners to take care of their pets by assigning tasks and activities to other members of the household. The website will incorporate a shared calendar and on-page notifications to help users track their pets' care and ensure there are no longer any missed walks, medication, or feedings.

2- Content and features that will be essential to the website will be:

- Main landing page
 - Quick view into recently completed tasks, with overdue tasks appearing on top if not completed
 - Calendar at the bottom in a mini form can be clicked to access
 - List of pets on top associated with personal account

- Pet Profile
 - Profile picture of pet
 - Information on feeding habits & upcoming schedule, etc
 - caregivers/family associated
- Calendar
 - Days accessible through calendar sidebar showing next upcoming task assigned to person's schedule; vet appointment days having important banners on them
 - Click on day view to see schedule hour by hour similar to a Google Calendar
 - Option to schedule new event on page
- personal/caregiver profile
 - Profile of person associated with a family
 - Contact information(profiles will only be visible to those in a family; outside of it, just a username)
- Task scheduler
 - Schedule tasks on the calendar and assign group/individual person(s) to the task
 - Recurring task or one-time task
 - Mark as important will be pushed to the top of the day on the calendar as an important task (vet appointment)

The home page will highlight the calendar with pet profiles at the top, ensure the next task is front and center so it is focused on and completed, and display the next important task in x days or hours as the largest element on the screen. The home page will also include the family dashboard and show a chart of who has completed what recently and the number of tasks completed. The top bar will include a login or create account if not signed in, or an account picture on the top right to access the personal account.

3- I want the website to feel like Google Calendar, especially on the calendar screen and in the ease of use for setting up tasks, but with a collaborative group screen where a system like that is comfortable for many people, especially since it's the main focus of the website and makes it easy for people comfortable with Google Calendar or Apple Calendar to migrate over to it and use it. I would also want to make the user experience similar to Chewy, with images of pets appearing in places and using simple imagery and a simple layout to make it not too complicated to use. For the style of the site, I would want to make it simple and appealing to all ages, with some images of pets dotting around on different screens, but keep it professional and remind people that it's about pet health, with the main color being green for the layout and bars, with the background being primarily white. An option for a dark mode would be a darker green background with white text and gray bars. It would be a mixture of playful and professional, with rounded letter fonts being used yet displaying information in a professional and easy-to-read manner.

Design & Prototyping

1-SDLC Model

For my website, I plan to use an Agile SDLC approach. Agile is a good fit because the website will include many features, such as a shared calendar, pet profiles, task assignments, notifications, user accounts, and gamification. Using Agile will allow me to build the website in smaller sections, test each feature, and make changes based on testing and feedback instead of waiting until the entire website is complete. I will use short development cycles, or sprints, with each sprint focusing on a specific part of the website. At the end of each sprint, I can test the feature, identify problems, and make improvements before continuing.

Timeline and Milestones

I plan to complete the project over approximately 10 weeks:

Week	SDLC Phase	Tasks	Milestone
1	Planning & Requirements	Define the purpose of the website, target audience, essential features, and project requirements.	Requirements completed
2	Analysis	Research similar websites, determine user needs, and organize the site's main functions.	Feature list finalized
3	Design	Create wireframes and determine the layout, colors, fonts, navigation, and overall visual style.	Initial prototype completed
4	Design & Prototyping	Create detailed mockups for the homepage, calendar, pet profiles, and task scheduler.	High-fidelity prototype completed
5	Development – Sprint 1	Build the basic website structure, navigation, homepage, and user profile system.	Basic website functional
6	Development – Sprint 2	Build pet profiles, shared family/group system, and task creation and assignment features.	Pet and task systems functional
7	Development – Sprint 3	Add the calendar, recurring tasks, notifications, and completed/overdue task tracking.	Core pet-care system completed
8	Development – Sprint 4	Add gamification features such as streaks, rewards, and the virtual pet. Improve mobile responsiveness.	Major features completed
9	Testing	Test navigation, task scheduling, calendar functions, notifications, responsiveness, and usability. Fix bugs and improve confusing areas.	Testing completed

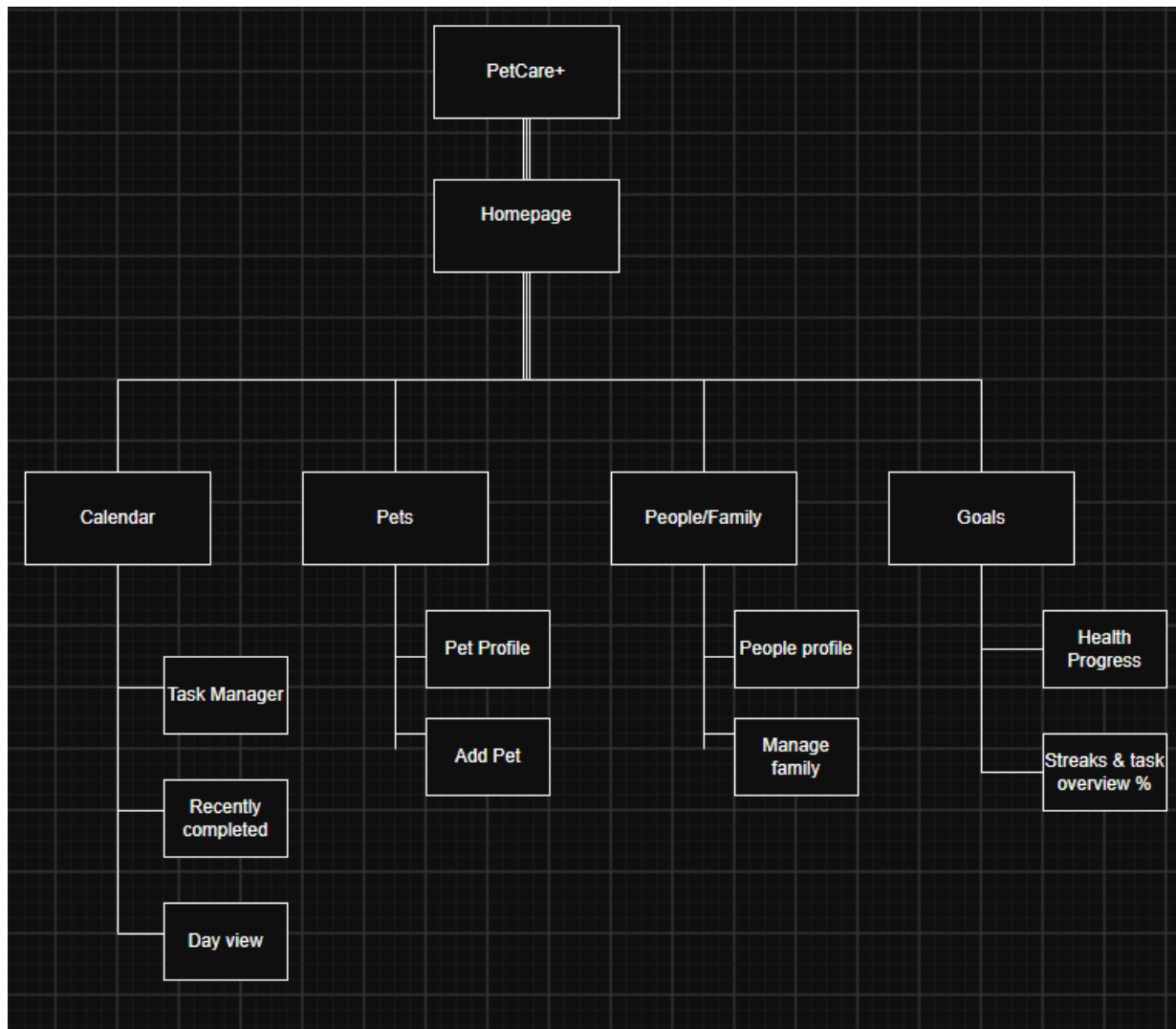
10	Deployment & Evaluation	Finalize the design, perform final testing, publish the website, and evaluate the	*document generated by ChatGPT
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Generated using Pixlr (temporary)

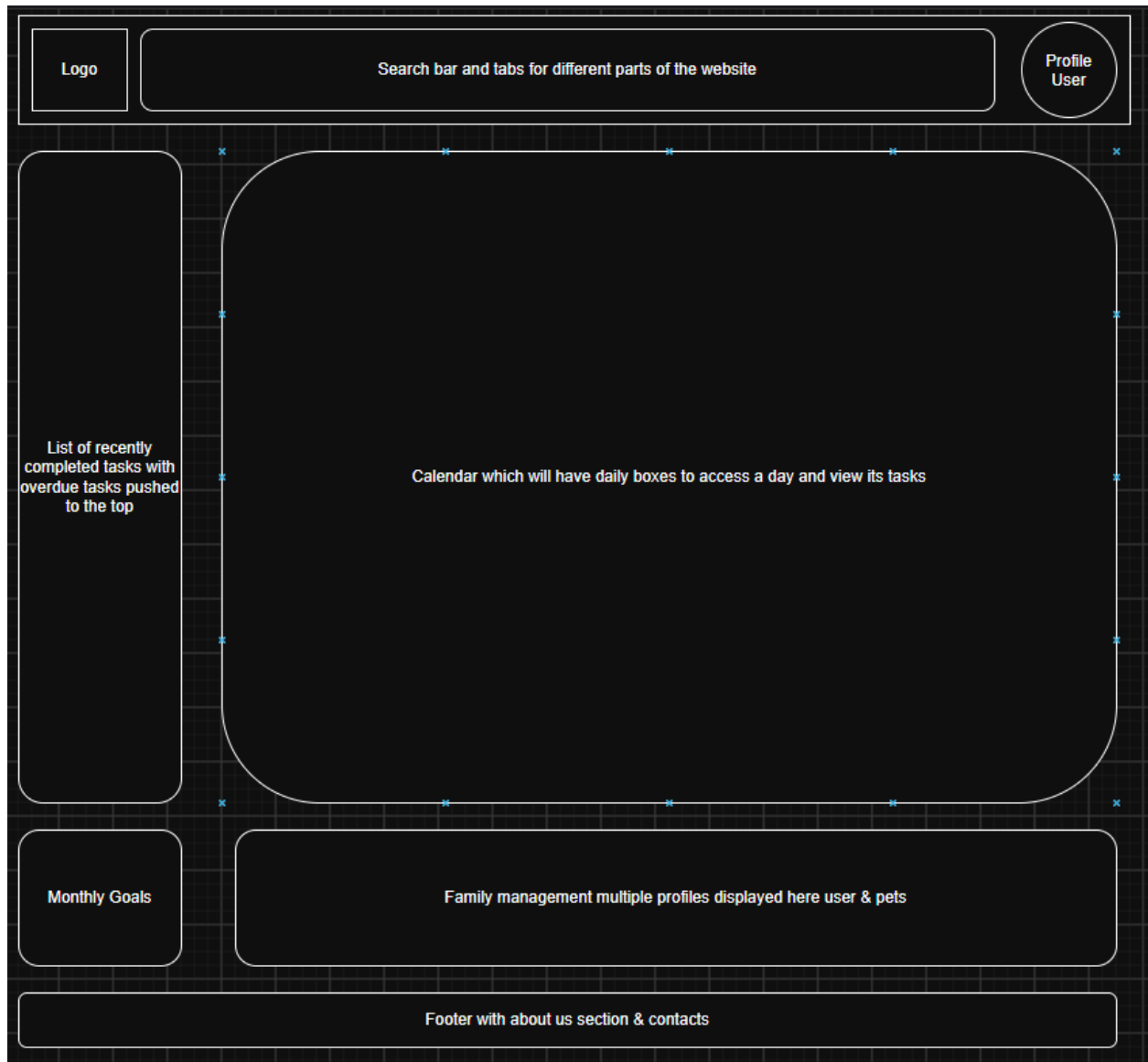
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Site wireframe: everything will be accessible through the homepage.

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Landing/main page contains the calendar, and the buttons and profiles will be clickable to lead to the next page.





Family screen allowing for management of users who are part of the family alongside the pet profiles that are part of it, with the bottom always being an open spot to add a new person or pet, scrollable.



Goals page that provides feedback on monthly goals or important milestones in the pet's health and life.

5- Accessibility will be done in many ways for differing disabilities and issues people may have.

- Visual impairments
 - Use clear, readable fonts and good colour contrast.
 - Add alt text to images so screen readers can describe them.
 - Make sure the website works with screen readers.
 - Allow users to zoom in without breaking the website.
- Hearing impairments
 - Add captions/subtitles to videos.
 - Provide text versions of important audio information.
 - Do not rely on sound alone to communicate important information.
- Motor impairments

- Make sure the website can be used with a keyboard instead of only a mouse.
- Use large, easy-to-click buttons and links.
- Give users enough time to complete forms or actions.
- Avoid features that require precise movements.
- Cognitive impairments
 - Use simple and clear language.
 - Keep the website layout consistent and easy to understand.
 - Use clear headings and menus.
 - Give helpful instructions and error messages on forms.
 - Avoid unnecessary animations and distractions.
- Accessibility testing tools
 - Use WAVE to find accessibility problems on individual pages.
 - Use Google Lighthouse to check accessibility and identify areas for improvement.
 - Use ChatGPT to review the website content and suggest improvements to language, structure, and accessibility.
 - Test the website manually using only a keyboard and, where possible, a screen reader.